

TeachLink Africa — Design System v2.0

Vision: The world's most trusted African teacher marketplace. Design that converts. Trust that compounds. **Stack:** Google AI Studio (Gemini API) + Firebase + Next.js 14 **Updated:** June 2026

1. Brand Identity

Attribute	Value
Platform name	TeachLink Africa
Tagline	"Africa's Best Teachers. The World's Best Students."
Personality	Trustworthy · Empowering · Premium · Warm · Global
Voice	Confident but never arrogant. Warm but never informal.
Target feel	"Stripe meets Preply, designed in Lagos"

2. Color System

CSS

```
:root {  
  /* === PRIMARY: Deep Forest Green – growth, education, Africa === */  
  --color-primary-50: #F0FBF5;  
  --color-primary-100: #DCFAEB;  
  --color-primary-200: #B5F0D1;  
  --color-primary-300: #7DDDB0;  
  --color-primary-400: #42C487;  
  --color-primary-500: #1A9E62; /* Main brand green */  
  --color-primary-600: #1A6B47; /* Primary CTA */  
  --color-primary-700: #145438;  
  --color-primary-800: #0F3D28;  
  --color-primary-900: #082818;  
  
  /* === ACCENT: Warm Gold – achievement, premium, warmth === */  
  --color-accent-50: #FFFBEB;  
  --color-accent-100: #FEF3C7;  
  --color-accent-200: #FDE68A;  
  --color-accent-300: #FCD34D;  
  --color-accent-400: #FBBF24;  
  --color-accent-500: #F59E0B; /* Stars, badges, highlights */  
  --color-accent-600: #D97706; /* Accent CTA hover */  
  --color-accent-700: #B45309;  
  
  /* === TRUST BLUE – verification, info, links === */  
  --color-trust-400: #60A5FA;  
  --color-trust-500: #3B82F6;  
  --color-trust-600: #2563EB;  
  
  /* === NEUTRALS – warm, never cold === */  
  --color-white: #FFFFFF;  
  --color-surface: #FAFAF8; /* Page background */  
  --color-surface-alt: #F4F1EC; /* Card background */  
  --color-surface-dark: #EDE9E2; /* Input background */  
  --color-border: #E0DBD2;  
  --color-border-dark: #C8C2B7;  
  
  --color-text-primary: #1A1916; /* Headlines */  
  --color-text-secondary: #4A4840; /* Body copy */  
  --color-text-muted: #8A8680; /* Placeholder, secondary labels */  
  --color-text-inverse: #FFFFFF;  
  
  /* === SEMANTIC === */  
  --color-success: #16A34A;
```

```
--color-success-bg:#DCFCE7;
--color-warning:    #D97706;
--color-warning-bg:#FEF3C7;
--color-error:      #DC2626;
--color-error-bg:   #FEE2E2;
--color-info:       #2563EB;
--color-info-bg:    #DBEAFE;

/* === DARK MODE === */
--color-dark-bg:     #0D110E;
--color-dark-surface: #141A15;
--color-dark-card:   #1C2420;
--color-dark-border: #2A342C;
--color-dark-text:   #E8E4DC;
--color-dark-muted:  #7A8078;
}
```

3. Typography

CSS

```
/*
  Google Fonts import – add to <head>
  Display: Cormorant Garamond – editorial authority, premium feel
  Body: Plus Jakarta Sans – modern, legible, warm
  Mono: JetBrains Mono – code, data, session IDs
*/
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Cormorant+Garamond:wght@500;600&family=Plus+Jakarta+Sans&display=swap&family=JetBrains+Mono:wght@400;500;600;700&subset=latin,latin-ext&v=1.20.3');

:root {
  --font-display: 'Cormorant Garamond', Georgia, serif;
  --font-body:    'Plus Jakarta Sans', system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-mono:    'JetBrains Mono', monospace;

  /* === Type Scale === */
  --text-2xs: 0.625rem; /* 10px – badge labels */
  --text-xs:  0.75rem;  /* 12px – captions, timestamps */
  --text-sm:  0.875rem; /* 14px – secondary body */
  --text-base: 1rem;    /* 16px – primary body */
  --text-lg:  1.125rem; /* 18px – lead paragraph */
  --text-xl:  1.25rem;  /* 20px – card titles */
  --text-2xl: 1.5rem;   /* 24px – section titles */
  --text-3xl: 1.875rem; /* 30px – page titles */
  --text-4xl: 2.25rem;  /* 36px – hero sub */
  --text-5xl: 3rem;     /* 48px – hero headline */
  --text-6xl: 3.75rem;  /* 60px – landing mega hero */
  --text-7xl: 4.5rem;   /* 72px – splash only */

  /* === Weight === */
  --weight-light: 300;
  --weight-regular: 400;
  --weight-medium: 500;
  --weight-semi: 600;
  --weight-bold: 700;

  /* === Line Height === */
  --leading-none: 1;
  --leading-tight: 1.2;
  --leading-snug: 1.35;
  --leading-normal: 1.6;
  --leading-relaxed: 1.75;

  /* === Letter Spacing === */
  --tracking-tight: -0.025em;
}
```

```
--tracking-normal: 0;
--tracking-wide: 0.05em;
--tracking-wider: 0.1em;
--tracking-widest: 0.2em; /* Eyebrow labels */
}
```

Type Usage Map

Element	Font	Size	Weight	Tracking
Landing hero	Cormorant Garamond	6xl-7xl	700	tight
Section headline	Cormorant Garamond	4xl-5xl	600	tight
Page title	Cormorant Garamond	3xl	600	normal
Eyebrow label	Plus Jakarta Sans	2xs	600	widest
Card title	Plus Jakarta Sans	xl	600	normal
Body copy	Plus Jakarta Sans	base	400	normal
UI labels	Plus Jakarta Sans	xs-sm	500	wide
Buttons	Plus Jakarta Sans	sm	600	wide
Stats / Numbers	Cormorant Garamond	4xl-5xl	700	tight
Timestamps / IDs	JetBrains Mono	xs	400	normal

4. Spacing System

CSS

```
:root {
  --space-px: 1px;
  --space-0: 0;
  --space-1: 0.25rem; /* 4px */
  --space-2: 0.5rem; /* 8px */
  --space-3: 0.75rem; /* 12px */
  --space-4: 1rem; /* 16px */
  --space-5: 1.25rem; /* 20px */
  --space-6: 1.5rem; /* 24px */
  --space-8: 2rem; /* 32px */
  --space-10: 2.5rem; /* 40px */
  --space-12: 3rem; /* 48px */
  --space-16: 4rem; /* 64px */
  --space-20: 5rem; /* 80px */
  --space-24: 6rem; /* 96px */
  --space-32: 8rem; /* 128px */
  --space-40: 10rem; /* 160px */
}
```

5. Border Radius

CSS

```
:root {
  --radius-xs: 0.25rem; /* 4px – chips, micro elements */
  --radius-sm: 0.5rem; /* 8px – small inputs */
  --radius-md: 0.75rem; /* 12px – inputs, small cards */
  --radius-lg: 1rem; /* 16px – standard cards */
  --radius-xl: 1.25rem; /* 20px – large cards */
  --radius-2xl: 1.5rem; /* 24px – modals, panels */
  --radius-3xl: 2rem; /* 32px – hero cards */
  --radius-full: 9999px; /* Pills, avatars, tags */
}
```

6. Shadow System

CSS

```
:root {  
  /* Base shadows */  
  --shadow-xs: 0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,0.04);  
  --shadow-sm: 0 1px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.06), 0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,0.04);  
  --shadow-md: 0 4px 16px rgba(0,0,0,0.08), 0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.04);  
  --shadow-lg: 0 12px 40px rgba(0,0,0,0.10), 0 4px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.06);  
  --shadow-xl: 0 24px 64px rgba(0,0,0,0.12), 0 8px 16px rgba(0,0,0,0.06);  
  --shadow-2xl: 0 40px 96px rgba(0,0,0,0.16);  
  
  /* Brand shadows (for CTAs, featured elements) */  
  --shadow-green: 0 8px 32px rgba(26,107,71,0.25), 0 2px 8px rgba(26,107,71,0.15);  
  --shadow-green-lg: 0 20px 60px rgba(26,107,71,0.30);  
  --shadow-gold: 0 8px 32px rgba(245,158,11,0.25), 0 2px 8px rgba(245,158,11,0.15);  
  
  /* Trust signal shadow */  
  --shadow-card-hover: 0 20px 60px rgba(0,0,0,0.12), 0 0 0 1px rgba(26,107,71,0.08);  
  
  /* Inner shadows */  
  --shadow-inner: inset 0 2px 4px rgba(0,0,0,0.06);  
}
```

7. Component Library

Buttons

CSS

```
/* === PRIMARY – Main conversion action === */
.btn-primary {
  display: inline-flex;
  align-items: center;
  gap: var(--space-2);
  background: var(--color-primary-600);
  color: var(--color-white);
  font-family: var(--font-body);
  font-size: var(--text-sm);
  font-weight: var(--weight-semi);
  letter-spacing: var(--tracking-wide);
  padding: var(--space-3) var(--space-6);
  border-radius: var(--radius-full);
  border: none;
  box-shadow: var(--shadow-green);
  cursor: pointer;
  transition: all 0.2s cubic-bezier(0.16,1,0.3,1);
  white-space: nowrap;
}
.btn-primary:hover {
  background: var(--color-primary-700);
  box-shadow: var(--shadow-green-lg);
  transform: translateY(-1px);
}
.btn-primary:active { transform: scale(0.97); }

/* === ACCENT – Hero CTA, highest conversion intent === */
.btn-accent {
  background: var(--color-accent-500);
  color: var(--color-text-primary);
  font-weight: var(--weight-bold);
  padding: var(--space-4) var(--space-8);
  border-radius: var(--radius-full);
  border: none;
  box-shadow: var(--shadow-gold);
  font-size: var(--text-base);
  cursor: pointer;
  transition: all 0.2s cubic-bezier(0.16,1,0.3,1);
}
.btn-accent:hover {
  background: var(--color-accent-600);
  transform: translateY(-2px);
}
```



```

/* === GHOST – Secondary actions === */
.btn-ghost {
  background: transparent;
  color: var(--color-primary-600);
  border: 1.5px solid var(--color-primary-600);
  padding: var(--space-3) var(--space-6);
  border-radius: var(--radius-full);
  font-size: var(--text-sm);
  font-weight: var(--weight-semi);
  cursor: pointer;
  transition: all 0.2s ease;
}
.btn-ghost:hover {
  background: var(--color-primary-50);
}

/* === SIZES === */
.btn-sm { padding: var(--space-2) var(--space-4); font-size: var(--text-xs); }
.btn-lg { padding: var(--space-4) var(--space-10); font-size: var(--text-lg); }
.btn-xl { padding: var(--space-5) var(--space-12); font-size: var(--text-xl); }

```

Teacher Profile Card

STRUCTURE (top to bottom):

[Video thumb / Avatar]	[Featured tag?]
● LIVE / Online indicator	
[Avatar 72px] ✓ Verified	
Teacher Name (xl, semi)	
★★★★★ 4.9 (247 reviews)	
📍 Lagos, Nigeria · 🌐 Teaches globally	
[Maths] [Physics] [WAEC] [JAMB]	
🏆 Top Rated ⚡ Fast Responder 🎓 AI	
"Taught 312 sessions · 98% on time"	
From ₦3,500/hr \$12/hr £9/hr	

[Book Trial Lesson] [Message]

STYLES:

- Background: --color-white
- Border: 1px solid --color-border
- Border-radius: --radius-2xl
- Shadow: --shadow-md
- Hover: --shadow-card-hover + translateY(-4px), transition 0.25s
- Width: 300px-340px in grid, 100% on mobile

Badge Component

css

```
.badge {
  display: inline-flex;
  align-items: center;
  gap: var(--space-1);
  padding: var(--space-1) var(--space-3);
  border-radius: var(--radius-full);
  font-size: var(--text-xs);
  font-weight: var(--weight-semi);
  letter-spacing: var(--tracking-wide);
  white-space: nowrap;
}

/* Badge variants */
.badge-verified { background: #DCFCE7; color: #166534; }
.badge-top-rated { background: var(--color-accent-100); color: var(--color-accent-400); }
.badge-featured { background: var(--color-primary-600); color: white; }
.badge-fast { background: #DBEAFE; color: #1E40AF; }
.badge-new { background: #F3E8FF; color: #6B21A8; }
.badge-ai-cert { background: linear-gradient(135deg,#DCFCE7,#DBEAFE); color: #065F4E; }
.badge-elite { background: linear-gradient(135deg,var(--color-accent-400),var(--color-accent-600)); color: white; box-shadow: var(--shadow-gold); }
.badge-streak { background: #FEF3C7; color: #92400E; }
.badge-intl { background: #F0FBE5; color: var(--color-primary-700); border: 1px solid var(--color-primary-200); }
```

Star Rating

CSS

```
.stars { display: flex; align-items: center; gap: var(--space-1); }
.star-filled { color: var(--color-accent-500); font-size: var(--text-sm); }
.star-empty { color: var(--color-border); }
.rating-score { font-family: var(--font-display); font-size: var(--text-xl);
                font-weight: var(--weight-bold); color: var(--color-text-primary); }
.rating-count { font-size: var(--text-sm); color: var(--color-text-muted); }
```

Session Clock Component

SESSION TIMER (shown during live session):

LIVE · 00:47:23

Session clocked · Auto-saving

[Pause] [End Session]

- Background: --color-dark-surface
- Accent: --color-error (red pulsing dot for LIVE)
- Font: JetBrains Mono for timer digits
- Position: Fixed top-right during active session
- Pulsing red dot animation: 2s ease-in-out infinite

Progress Card (Parent Dashboard)

STUDENT PROGRESS CARD:

Mathematics · WAEC SSS1

Teacher: Mr. Adebayo Okafor

Attendance

89%

Assignments

76% submitted

Avg. Score

82/100

↑ +12% improvement this month

AI Insight: "Strong in algebra,

needs work on trigonometry"

[View Full Report] [Message Teacher]

8. Layout System

CSS

```

/* Container */
.container      { max-width: 1280px; margin: 0 auto; padding: 0 var(--space-6); }
.container-sm    { max-width: 768px;  margin: 0 auto; padding: 0 var(--space-6); }
.container-lg    { max-width: 1440px; margin: 0 auto; padding: 0 var(--space-8); }

/* Breakpoints */
/* --bp-xs: 480px  - small mobile */
/* --bp-sm: 640px  - mobile       */
/* --bp-md: 768px  - tablet       */
/* --bp-lg: 1024px - laptop        */
/* --bp-xl: 1280px - desktop       */
/* --bp-2xl:1536px - wide         */

/* Teacher Grid */
.teacher-grid {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fill, minmax(290px, 1fr));
  gap: var(--space-6);
}

/* Dashboard Grid */
.dashboard-grid {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: 260px 1fr;
  gap: var(--space-8);
  min-height: 100vh;
}

/* Stat Cards Row */
.stats-row {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fit, minmax(180px, 1fr));
  gap: var(--space-4);
}

```

9. Motion System

CSS

```

:root {
  /* Easing curves */
  --ease-spring: cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1);
  --ease-smooth: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1);
  --ease-in: cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 1, 1);
  --ease-out: cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1);

  /* Durations */
  --duration-fast: 100ms;
  --duration-base: 200ms;
  --duration-slow: 350ms;
  --duration-slower: 500ms;
  --duration-page: 600ms;
}

/* Stagger for card grids */
.teacher-card:nth-child(1) { animation-delay: 0ms; }
.teacher-card:nth-child(2) { animation-delay: 60ms; }
.teacher-card:nth-child(3) { animation-delay: 120ms; }
.teacher-card:nth-child(n) { animation-delay: calc(n * 60ms); }

/* Fade up entrance */
@keyframes fadeUp {
  from { opacity: 0; transform: translateY(20px); }
  to { opacity: 1; transform: translateY(0); }
}
.animate-fade-up { animation: fadeUp var(--duration-slow) var(--ease-spring) both; }

/* Pulse (LIVE indicator) */
@keyframes pulse-live {
  0%, 100% { opacity: 1; transform: scale(1); }
  50% { opacity: 0.6; transform: scale(1.4); }
}
.dot-live { animation: pulse-live 2s ease-in-out infinite; }

/* Shimmer skeleton */
@keyframes shimmer {
  from { background-position: -400px 0; }
  to { background-position: 400px 0; }
}
.skeleton {
  background: linear-gradient(90deg,
    var(--color-surface-alt) 25%,

```

```

    var(--color-surface-dark) 50%,
    var(--color-surface-alt) 75%);
background-size: 800px 100%;
animation: shimmer 1.4s ease infinite;
border-radius: var(--radius-md);
}

```

10. Iconography

- **Library:** Lucide (primary) + custom SVG for brand icons
- **Sizes:** 14px (dense UI), 16px (inline), 20px (buttons/nav), 24px (feature), 32px (section icons), 48px (empty states)
- **Color:** Context-sensitive (never decorative without meaning)
- **Custom icons needed:** TeachLink logo mark, Badge icons (per badge type), Subject icons (Maths, Science, English, etc.)

11. Trust Signal Design

Homepage Trust Bar (below hero)

🛡️ Verified Teachers	💰 Escrow Protection	★ 4.9 Avg
✓ Background Checks	🌍 50+ Countries	🔒 NDPR/GDPR

Background: --color-primary-600 | Text: white

Social Proof Counter (animated, real-time feel)

12,400+ lessons taught this week
 4,200+ verified teachers
 98 countries reached

Money-Back Banner

"Not satisfied after your first lesson? Full refund. No questions."
 Background: --color-accent-100 | Border-left: 4px solid --color-accent-500

12. Accessibility Standards

Rule	Requirement
Color contrast body	Minimum 4.5:1
Color contrast large text	Minimum 3:1
Focus indicator	2px outline, --color-primary-500, 2px offset
Touch targets	Minimum 44×44px
Font minimum	14px rendered
Forms	Visible labels always (never placeholder-only)
Images	Descriptive alt text required
Animation	Respect <code>prefers-reduced-motion</code>
Screen readers	Semantic HTML, ARIA roles for custom components

css

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {  
  *, *::before, *::after {  
    animation-duration: 0.01ms !important;  
    transition-duration: 0.01ms !important;  
  }  
}
```

13. Currency Display Rules

js


```
// Format currency for display
const formatCurrency = (amount, currency) => {
  const formatters = {
    NGN: new Intl.NumberFormat('en-NG', { style:'currency', currency:'NGN', minimumF
    USD: new Intl.NumberFormat('en-US', { style:'currency', currency:'USD' }),
    GBP: new Intl.NumberFormat('en-GB', { style:'currency', currency:'GBP' }),
    EUR: new Intl.NumberFormat('de-DE', { style:'currency', currency:'EUR' }),
    GHS: new Intl.NumberFormat('en-GH', { style:'currency', currency:'GHS' }),
    CAD: new Intl.NumberFormat('en-CA', { style:'currency', currency:'CAD' }),
  };
  return formatters[currency]?.format(amount) ?? ` ${currency} ${amount}`;
};

// Teacher rate display: show in teacher's currency + visitor's currency
// "¥3,500/hr · ~$4.20/hr"
```

14. Session Status Colors

Status	Background	Text	Dot color
Scheduled	☐ #DBEAFE	☒ #1E40AF	☒ #3B82F6
Live (now)	☒ #DCFCE7	☒ #166534	☒ #16A34A (pulse)
Completed	☐ #F0FBF5	☒ #1A6B47	☒ #1A6B47
Cancelled	☐ #FEE2E2	☒ #991B1B	☒ #DC2626
Disputed	☐ #FEF3C7	☒ #92400E	☒ #D97706
Pending	var(--color-surface-alt)	--color-text-muted	☐ #9CA3AF

15. File + Folder Structure

```
/app
  /(auth)
    /login
    /register
```

```
  /onboarding
/(dashboard)
  /teacher      # Teacher dashboard
  /parent      # Parent dashboard
  /admin       # Admin panel
  /teachers    # Public teacher listing
  /teachers/[slug] # Teacher profile (SEO)
  /session/[id] # Live session room
  /academy     # AI Upskilling modules
  /academy/[module]

/components
  /ui          # Button, Badge, Card, Input, Modal, Avatar
  /teacher     # TeacherCard, TeacherProfile, SessionTimer
  /parent      # ProgressCard, AssessmentLog, PaymentHistory
  /session     # VideoRoom, Clock, RecordingControls, Chat
  /academy     # CourseCard, ModulePlayer, QuizEngine, Certificate
  /shared      # Navbar, Footer, TrustBar, SearchBar, CurrencyToggle

/lib
  /gemini.ts   # Google AI Studio / Gemini API client
  /firebase.ts # Firebase config (auth, firestore, storage)
  /paystack.ts # Paystack payment helpers
  /stripe.ts   # Stripe payment helpers
  /wise.ts     # Wise payout API
  /zoom.ts     # Zoom SDK integration
  /currency.ts # Exchange rate + formatting
  /time.ts     # Session clock, timezone utils

/hooks
  useSession.ts      # Live session state
  useSessionClock.ts # Timer logic
  useTeacher.ts      # Teacher profile + availability
  useProgress.ts     # Student progress data
  useCurrency.ts     # Currency detection + conversion

/styles
  globals.css      # Reset + CSS variables
  typography.css
  components.css
  animations.css

/tokens
  colors.ts
```

16. Database Schema (Firebase Firestore)

Collections:

users/	{ uid, role, email, createdAt, country }
teachers/ verified, stats }	{ uid, bio, subjects, rates, ratings, badges, availability,
parents/	{ uid, children[], paymentMethods[], preferences }
students/	{ uid, parentUid, subjects, progress{}, xp, badges }
sessions/	{ id, teacherId, studentId, parentId, status, startTime,
endTime,	duration, zoomLink, recording, clockLog[], subject }
assignments/	{ id, sessionId, teacherId, studentId, title, dueDate,
	submission, grade, feedback, status }
reviews/	{ id, sessionId, parentId, teacherId, rating, dimensions{},
	comment, teacherReply, createdAt }
messages/	{ id, participants[], messages[], lastActivity }
transactions/	{ id, amount, currency, status, fromUser, toUser, sessionId,
	commissionAmount, payoutStatus, createdAt }
badges/	{ id, name, description, icon, trigger, earnedBy[] }
notifications/	{ id, userId, type, message, read, createdAt }
academy_progress/	{ userId, moduleId, status, score, completedAt, certificate }
disputes/	{ id, sessionId, raisedBy, reason, status, resolution,
adminNotes }	